MANE MAP

The Hair System Starter Pack

Everything you need to know before your first appointment

by @jaredhashair-manemap.com

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Why This Exists

Most guys spend months figuring this out.

I did too. This guide covers everything I wish someone had handed me before my first consultation: base types, what to expect, what to ask, and what maintenance actually looks like. Read this once and you'll walk in more prepared than 90% of first-timers.

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SECTION 01

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Understanding Base Types

The base is what the hair is attached to and what sits against your scalp. Choosing the wrong one for your lifestyle is the most common first-timer mistake.

Here's what you need to know →

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SECTION 01

Polyurethane (Poly): Thin Skin

0.02mm-0.04mm

Most natural-looking hairline

Best for **exposed hairline styles**: slicked back, brushed up, anything where the front is on display. Takes adhesive really well, easy to clean. May feel warmer if you're a heavy sweater, though plenty of moderate-activity guys wear it comfortably. Replaces every 2–3 months.

SECTION 01

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Poly: Thicker

0.06mm-0.08mm

More durable, lasts longer, best with unexposed hairlines

Better for forward, tousled, or messy looks where the hairline isn't front and center. The slightly more visible edge is hidden by your hairstyle. Lasts 4–5 months. Longer between replacements means **lower overall cost**.

SECTION 01

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Lace & Hybrid

Most breathable option

If you're in the gym regularly, live somewhere warm, or are a heavy sweater, **lace** was made for you. Lightweight mesh base, extremely comfortable. **Hybrid** combines lace in the center with poly around the perimeter for easier attachment. Both last 4–5 months. Full lace requires more careful maintenance than poly or hybrid.

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SECTION 01

The Simple Rule

Active+heavy sweater → **Lace or hybrid**

Exposed hairline → **Thin skin poly**

Durability/obscured hairline → **Thicker poly**

Your specialist will help confirm the right choice for you, based on your life-style and preferences.

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SECTION 02

Your First 24-48 Hours

Give your bond 24–48 hours to fully set before any water exposure. Wear a shower cap when showering, no swimming, no intense sweating.

This isn't forever. It's just the first two days while the adhesive cures properly.

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SECTION 03



The Week One Reality Check

The first week is the hardest. Not physically, just mentally. You'll check the mirror constantly looking for the line. You'll wonder if people can tell. **They can't.**

By week two, most guys stop looking for it and just see their hair. The guys who struggle longest walked in without realistic expectations. Now you have them.

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SECTION 04

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What Maintenance Actually Looks Like

Partial DIY

Salon installs your new system, you maintain at home. Every 10–14 days: remove the system, clean old adhesive from the base and scalp, prep the scalp, use your preferred adhesive, and reinstall. About 1.5 hours including the shower. Muscle memory by month three.

Full Salon

They handle everything, every visit. No maintenance knowledge required. Simpler, but it adds up. For a lot of guys that tradeoff is completely worth it.

Depending on your lifestyle, a quick touch-up at the front hairline may be needed (15 min).

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SECTION 05

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What to Ask at Your First Appointment

- What bases do you specialize in?
- What adhesives do you use any why?
- Do you work with systems clients bring in?
- What does the maintenance schedule look like?
- Can you walk me through home maintenance?
- What's the realistic replacement timeline for this base?

A specialist who welcomes these questions is the right one.

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Ready to find your specialist?

Mane Map connects you with verified hair system specialists across the US, who have been pre-screened. Not only will you walk in confident and prepared, but you'll walk out confident and with hair.

Find your specialist at manemap.com

@jaredhashair-Built by a real wearer

ALL ABOUT ADHESIVES

Not all adhesives are the same.

Different glues are built for different priorities:

- ✓ Hold strength
- ✓ Skin Sensitivity
- ✓ Wear Time
- ✓ Water Resistance

Knowing the difference changes how you approach your decision.

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ADHESIVE 01

Ultra Hold

Maximum Performance

Bond: 4+ weeks

Strongest bond. Longest wear. Solvent-based, which is where the strong smell comes from. Built for those who need their hair system locked in for an active lifestyle. Sweating, swimming, heat... hold my beer.

Best for: Max hold & durability

ADHESIVE 02

Great White

Gentle on skin

Bond: 2-4 weeks

Water-based. Low odor. Easy on sensitive skin. Trade off: shorter wear cycle. Perfect if your skin reacts to solvent-based formulas.

Best for: Sensitive skin

ADHESIVE 03

GhostBond XL

One of my favorites

Bond: 2-4 weeks

Water-based, latex free, moinsture control. Comfortable with a strong hold, even with oily skin. It’s popular for a reason and works great if you have sensitive skin.



Best for: All-around balance

ADHESIVE 04

Adhere 360

The hybrid

Bond: 3-4 weeks

Water-based but longer hold than most. Performance meets comfort. If you want strong without harsh, this is the one.

Best for: Strength + gentle

QUICK GUIDE

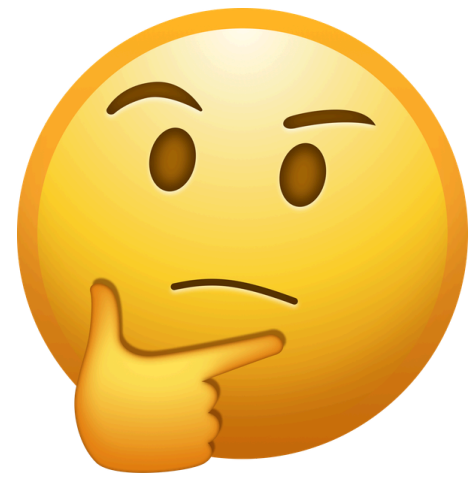
Which one is yours?

⚡ Max hold → **Ultra Hold**

🤍 Sensitive Skin → **Great White**

👻 Balance → **Ghostbond XL**

⚫ Strong+Gentle → **Adhere 360**



“Does it absorb into your body/brain? ”

Great question! Answer on the next slide.

ELI5

Here’s how it actually works.

01 Adhesives are made of large molecules called polymers.

02 When they dry, they form a solid layer on the surface of your skin.

03 They sit on top, not absorb into your body.

The Nuance

What actually happens during application.

Some smaller ingredients (molecules like solvents in Ultra Hold) evaporate as the adhesive dries. That’s what you smell when applying. Once it’s set? You’re left with a surface bond that stays on the skin, not in your blood stream. It’s not a chemical IV drip.

Real vs Fear

Know the difference.

✓ REAL	✗ FEAR
Skin irritation or sensitivity	*“It absorbs into your brain”*
Allergic reactions (patch test!)	*“All glues are bad”*
Ventilation during solvent use	*“Has to be toxic”*

Don’t make decisions off scary words.

“Chemicals” aren’t inherently bad.
Water is a chemical. Context matters!

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“Bald is not a hairstyle”.

Jared,
Mane Map Founder